Transportation Trends in Canada

By definition, transport means to convey (persons, goods, troops, baggage, etc) from one place to another. In a country as large as Canada, this is accomplished by a variety of means. The first explorers and native Indians moved by canoe on nature's own highways, that is, by waterways of rivers and lakes. Eventually, trails were cleared and became roads and people could move further inland by horse and carriage. It wasn't until the middle of the 1800's that one could cross this country by train with the building of the first Trans-Canada rail line and the use of steam engines. Cars, trolleys and trucks were not common until the early nineteenth century and air travel wasn't used on any regular basis until the mid-1900. It wasn't until after the Second World War ended in 1945 that Canadians had the technology and manpower for mass production of cars, airplanes, diesel-engine trains and buses. But moving machines are not the only means of transporting goods. Pipelines are becoming increasingly important, as Canada becomes an important producer of oil, gas and liquid petroleum.

Table 1: Ecozone statistics

Ecozone names	Coastal Length	Population 1996	Road Length (km)	Road Density
Arctic Cordillera	15460	1196	44	0.0002
Northern Arctic	93816	18881	726	0.0005
Southern Arctic	25863	11729	98	0.0002
Taiga Plains	95	23986	6360	0.0116
Taiga Shield	13370	36560	4663	0.0043
Boreal Shield	17664	2894961	236615	0.1460
Atlantic Maritime	10748	2549061	154724	0.7866
Mixedwood Plains	227	14840411	133591	1.2169
Boreal Plains		745172	164242	0.2472
Prairies		3979522	296304	0.6526
Taiga Cordillera		358	1718	0.0066
Boreal Cordillera		30324	8323	0.0185
Pacific Maritime	23138	2848289	38530	0.1911
Montane Cordillera		851656	103223	0.2191
Hudson Plains	3190	11811	1684	0.0049

Information on different means of transportation

Railways:
total: 36,114 km; note - there are two major transcontinental freight railway systems: Canadian National (privatized November 1995) and Canadian Pacific Railway; passenger service provided by government-operated firm VIA, which has no trackage of its own
standard gauge: 36,114 km 1.435-m gauge (156 km electrified) (1998)

Highways:
total: 901,902 km
paved: 318,371 km (including 16,571 km of expressways)
unpaved: 583,531 km (1999 est.)

Waterways:
3,000 km, including Saint Lawrence Seaway

Pipelines:
crude and refined oil 23,564 km; natural gas 74,980 km

Ports:
Becancour (Qc), Churchill (MN), Halifax (NS), Hamilton (ON), Montreal (QC), New Westminster (BC), Prince Rupert (BC), Quebec (QC), Saint John (NB), St. John's (NF), Sept Isles (QC), Sydney (NS), Trois-Rivieres (QC), Thunder Bay (ON), Toronto (ON), Vancouver (BC), Windsor (ON).

Merchant marine:
total: 114 ships (1,000 GRT or over) totaling 1,602,275 GRT/2,371,146 DWT
ships by type: barge carrier 1, bulk 61, cargo 11, chemical tanker 5, combination bulk 2, passenger 3, passenger/cargo 1, petroleum tanker 16, rail car carrier 2, roll-on/roll-off 8, short-sea passenger 3, specialized tanker 1 (1999 est.)
note: does not include ships used exclusively in the Great Lakes (1998 est.)

Airports:
1,411 (1999 est.)
<u>Airports - with paved runways:</u>
total: 515
over 3,047 m: 16
2,438 to 3,047 m: 17
1,524 to 2,437 m: 152
914 to 1,523 m: 240
under 914 m: 90 (1999 est.)
<u>Airports - with unpaved runways:</u>
total: 896
1,524 to 2,437 m: 73
914 to 1,523 m: 362
under 914 m: 461 (1999 est.)

Heliports:
15 (1999 est.)